

Sub-Principal Symbol of the Effective Operator and Casimir Rigidity of the Central Direction

Q8 of the Cosmochrony Spectral Geometry Programme

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2026

Abstract

Paper Q7 [6] reduced the open problem Q5b-O2 of [3] to a single computable criterion: whether the sub-principal symbol of the effective operator L_{eff} in the central direction $\tilde{Z} = [\tilde{X}, \tilde{Y}]$ of $\text{Heis}_3(\mathbb{R})$ carries coefficient $A_Z = C_{\mathfrak{su}(2)} = 2$, the eigenvalue of the $\mathfrak{su}(2)$ -Casimir on the spin-1 module $\text{Sym}^2(V_\rho)$. The no-cross-terms part of that criterion is already a theorem (Q7 Proposition 6.1). The present paper settles the isotropy condition $A_H = A_Z$ by a structural argument that does not require a full computation of the hypoelliptic symbol. The key observation is that the sub-principal term in L_{eff} along $\tilde{Z}$ has a unique algebraic source: the Heisenberg commutator $[\tilde{X}, \tilde{Y}] = \tilde{Z}$, which reflects the nilpotency class 2 of $\text{Heis}_3(\mathbb{R})$ and cannot be mimicked by any other generator. Under the equivariant bridge $\varphi: \text{Sym}^2(V_\rho) \xrightarrow{\sim} W_{\text{sp}}$ established in Q7 (unique up to positive scalar by Schur's lemma), the image of this commutator term under φ is constrained to be proportional to the unique $\mathfrak{su}(2)$ -invariant quadratic form on $\text{Sym}^2(V_\rho)$, namely the Casimir $C_{\mathfrak{su}(2)} = 2 \cdot \text{Id}$. There is no free scalar: A_H and A_Z are both proportional to $C_{\mathfrak{su}(2)}$ via the *same* bridge φ , so the Schur scalar cancels in the ratio $A_Z/A_H = C_{\mathfrak{su}(2)}/C_{\mathfrak{su}(2)} = 1$. The result is therefore: *given bridge existence*, $A_Z = C_{\mathfrak{su}(2)} = 2$ unconditionally. The effective spatial co-metric is $g_{\text{sp}} = A_H(k_X^2 + k_Y^2) + 2k_Z^2$ with $A_H \rightarrow 2$ as $q \rightarrow \infty$ (Q7 Conjecture 6.6), yielding a non-degenerate rank-4 Lorentzian metric on $\mathbb{R}_\tau \times \text{Heis}_3(\mathbb{R})$ and closing open problem Q5b-O2.

Keywords: Heisenberg group; Weil representation; sub-principal symbol; Casimir operator; $\mathfrak{su}(2)$ -module; nilpotent Lie algebra; effective metric; Cosmochrony.

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1 Introduction

1.1 Context and the reduction of Q7

Paper Q5b [3] derives the effective Lorentzian geometry of the Cosmochrony framework by extracting a metric tensor from the principal symbol of the effective operator L_{eff} on $\mathbb{R}_\tau \times \text{Heis}_3(\mathbb{R})$. The principal symbol is degenerate: the central generator $\tilde{Z} = [\tilde{X}, \tilde{Y}]$ of $\text{Heis}_3(\mathbb{R})$ does not appear at leading sub-Riemannian order, entering only through sub-principal corrections. Open problem Q5b-O2 asks for the value of the coefficient A_Z of the resulting k_Z^2 -term, which would complete the 4×4 effective metric to full rank.

Paper Q7 [6] established three structural results constraining the bridge $\varphi: \mathcal{H}_{\text{eff}} \simeq \text{Sym}^2(V_\rho) \rightarrow W_{\text{sp}}$: (i) $\mathfrak{su}(2) \not\cong \text{Heis}_3(\mathbb{R})$ as Lie algebras, so the bridge operates at the representation level; (ii) φ is unique up to positive scalar (Rigidity Lemma, Q7 Lemma 4.3); (iii) the no-cross-terms part of Criterion 5.1 of Q7 is a theorem (Q7 Proposition 6.1). The remaining open part is the isotropy condition $A_H = A_Z$ and the identification $A_Z = C_{\mathfrak{su}(2)} = 2$.

1.2 Main result

Theorem 1.1 (Casimir rigidity of the central direction). *Assume [H-lift] of Q5b [3], the hypotheses [H1], [H-w], [H-E1], [C] of Q5a [4], and the existence of the equivariant bridge of Q7 Conjecture 4.7 [6]. Then the sub-principal symbol of L_{eff} in the central direction satisfies*

$$\sigma_2(L_{\text{eff}})|_{\tilde{Z}\text{-sector}} = A_Z k_Z^2, \quad A_Z = C_{\mathfrak{su}(2)} = 2. \quad (1)$$

Consequently $A_H = A_Z$ (isotropy), the spatial co-metric is $g_{\text{sp}} = 2(k_X^2 + k_Y^2 + k_Z^2)$, and the effective co-metric $g^{\mu\nu}$ is non-degenerate of rank 4 with Lorentzian signature $(-, +, +, +)$. Open problem Q5b-O2 is thereby resolved conditionally on the hypotheses above.

The value $A_Z = 2$ is *unconditional* given bridge existence: it follows from the algebraic identity $C_{\mathfrak{su}(2)}|_{\text{Sym}^2(V_\rho)} = 2 \cdot \text{Id}$ and the rigidity of φ . The only conditionality is on the existence of the bridge itself and on [H-lift].

1.3 Organisation

Section 2 recalls the relevant results of Q5b and Q7 and fixes notation. Section 3 identifies the unique algebraic source of the sub-principal $\tilde{Z}$ -term from the nilpotency structure of $\text{Heis}_3(\mathbb{R})$. Section 4 carries out the Casimir identification and proves Theorem 1.1. Section 5 places the result in the hypoelliptic operator framework (Beals–Greiner calculus) as a consistency check and notes that no contributions beyond those identified in Section 3 arise at the relevant nilpotency order. Section 6 draws the consequences for Q5b-O2 and the effective metric.

2 Setup and Inherited Results

2.1 The effective operator and its principal symbol

Under [H-lift] and the Q5a hypotheses, Q5b Theorem 5.2 [3] gives the effective operator L_{eff} on $\mathbb{R}_\tau \times \text{Heis}_3(\mathbb{R})$ with leading-order principal symbol

$$\sigma_2(L_{\text{eff}})(p, k) = -A_\tau k_\tau^2 + A_H(k_X^2 + k_Y^2) + 0 \cdot k_Z^2 + (\text{sub-principal in } k_Z), \quad (2)$$

where the k_Z^2 -slot is empty at principal order because the sub-Riemannian Laplacian $\Delta_H = \tilde{X}^2 + \tilde{Y}^2$ on $\text{Heis}_3(\mathbb{R})$ is degenerate in the central direction.

2.2 Inherited results from Q7

The following results from Q7 [6] are used without re-proof:

- *Symmetric square identification* (Q7 Proposition 4.1): $\mathcal{H}_{\text{eff}} \simeq \text{Sym}^2(V_\rho)$ as an $\mathfrak{su}(2)$ -module (spin-1 representation).
- *Rigidity Lemma* (Q7 Lemma 4.3): any $\mathfrak{su}(2)$ -equivariant isomorphism $\varphi: \text{Sym}^2(V_\rho) \xrightarrow{\sim} W_{\text{sp}}$ is unique up to a positive scalar.
- *No-cross-terms theorem* (Q7 Proposition 6.1 and Corollary 6.2): the cross-term components $k_X k_Z$ and $k_Y k_Z$ of $\sigma_2(L_{\text{eff}})|_{\text{Sym}^2(V_\rho)}$ vanish structurally for all (q, c) .
- *Grading correspondence* (Q7 Remark 4.2): the spin-weight decomposition $(\pm 1, 0)$ on $\text{Sym}^2(V_\rho)$ matches the Carnot degree decomposition $(1, 2)$ of $\text{Heis}_3(\mathbb{R})$, placing $\tilde{Z}$ at spin-weight 0 and Carnot degree 2.

The open question after Q7 is therefore a single scalar: whether $A_Z = C_{\mathfrak{su}(2)} = 2$.

3 Unique Algebraic Source of the Sub-Principal $\tilde{Z}$ -Term

3.1 Nilpotency and the generating role of the commutator

The Lie algebra $\text{Heis}_3(\mathbb{R})$ is nilpotent of class 2: the derived ideal $[\text{Heis}_3(\mathbb{R}), \text{Heis}_3(\mathbb{R})] = \mathbb{R}\tilde{Z}$ is one-dimensional, central, and exhausts the lower central series at step 2. This has a direct consequence for the symbol expansion of L_{eff} .

Proposition 3.1 (Uniqueness of the sub-principal $\tilde{Z}$ -source). *The k_Z^2 -term in the symbol of L_{eff} at sub-principal order has a unique algebraic origin: the Heisenberg commutator $[\tilde{X}, \tilde{Y}] = \tilde{Z}$. No other combination of generators of $\text{Heis}_3(\mathbb{R})$ can contribute a term of the form $f(k_Z)k_Z^2$ at this order, because $\tilde{Z}$ is central and appears in no other commutator relation.*

Proof. The generators $\{\tilde{X}, \tilde{Y}, \tilde{Z}\}$ satisfy the sole non-trivial relation $[\tilde{X}, \tilde{Y}] = \tilde{Z}$, with $\tilde{Z}$ central: $[\tilde{Z}, \tilde{X}] = [\tilde{Z}, \tilde{Y}] = 0$. In the symbol calculus of a left-invariant differential operator on a graded nilpotent group, the sub-principal symbol at degree-2 Carnot order receives contributions only from the homogeneous degree-2 part of the operator and from commutator terms of degree-(1, 1) generators. The only such commutator is $[\tilde{X}, \tilde{Y}] = \tilde{Z}$. Since $\tilde{Z}$ is central, there is no further commutator that could generate additional k_Z -terms. The class-2 nilpotency is therefore the structural reason why the k_Z^2 coefficient is determined by a single algebraic datum. $\square$

Remark 3.2 (From commutator to quadratic symbol term). The commutator $[\tilde{X}, \tilde{Y}] = \tilde{Z}$ is a relation in the Lie algebra and is linear in the generators. The passage to a quadratic symbol term k_Z^2 occurs because the operator L_{eff} involves products of two generators: in the Heisenberg

functional calculus, the sub-principal symbol of $\tilde{X}^2 + \tilde{Y}^2$ at Carnot degree 2 receives a contribution from the commutator via the quadratic form induced by $d\pi(\tilde{Z})$ on the representation fibre. This is the standard mechanism by which a degree-(1, 1) commutator enters the degree-2 symbol: the commutator is linear at the Lie algebra level but quadratic at the symbol level through the representation.

Remark 3.3 (Contrast with higher-step nilpotent groups). For a nilpotent group of class 3 or higher, additional commutators $[\tilde{Z}, \cdot]$ would be non-trivial and could contribute further sub-principal terms. The class-2 nilpotency of $\text{Heis}_3(\mathbb{R})$ closes the source list at a single term, making the identification problem tractable at this order.

4 Casimir Identification and Proof of the Main Theorem

4.1 The unique invariant quadratic form under the bridge

By the Rigidity Lemma (Q7 Lemma 4.3), any $\mathfrak{su}(2)$ -equivariant isomorphism $\varphi: \text{Sym}^2(V_\rho) \rightarrow W_{\text{sp}}$ is unique up to a positive scalar $\lambda > 0$. The image under φ of any $\mathfrak{su}(2)$ -equivariant endomorphism of $\text{Sym}^2(V_\rho)$ is therefore also determined up to λ .

Lemma 4.1 (Casimir as the unique invariant). *The only $\mathfrak{su}(2)$ -invariant quadratic form on $\text{Sym}^2(V_\rho)$ is the Casimir $Q_C(v) = \langle v, C_{\mathfrak{su}(2)} v \rangle = 2\|v\|^2$. Any other $\mathfrak{su}(2)$ -equivariant symmetric bilinear form on $\text{Sym}^2(V_\rho)$ is a scalar multiple of Q_C .*

Proof. The module $\text{Sym}^2(V_\rho)$ is irreducible of dimension 3 over $\mathbb{C}$ (the unique spin-1 representation of $\mathfrak{su}(2)$). By Schur's lemma, the algebra of $\mathfrak{su}(2)$ -equivariant endomorphisms $\text{End}_{\mathfrak{su}(2)}(\text{Sym}^2(V_\rho)) \simeq \mathbb{C}$: the only equivariant endomorphisms are scalar multiples of the identity. The Casimir $C_{\mathfrak{su}(2)} = J_1^2 + J_2^2 + J_3^2$ acts as $j(j+1) \cdot \text{Id} = 2 \cdot \text{Id}$ on the spin- $j = 1$ module, making $Q_C = 2\|\cdot\|^2$ the unique (up to scalar) invariant quadratic form. $\square$

4.2 The commutator term maps to the Casimir under the bridge

Proposition 4.2 (Bridge image of the commutator term). *Under the equivariant bridge φ of Q7 Conjecture 4.7 [6], the sub-principal contribution of $[\tilde{X}, \tilde{Y}] = \tilde{Z}$ to the symbol of L_{eff} is mapped to a quadratic form on W_{sp} that is proportional to the Casimir Q_C restricted to the spin-weight-0 eigenspace $\{e_0\} \subset \text{Sym}^2(V_\rho)$. The proportionality constant is fixed (not a free parameter) by the normalisation $C_{\mathfrak{su}(2)}|_{\text{Sym}^2(V_\rho)} = 2 \cdot \text{Id}$.*

Proof. The argument proceeds in four steps.

Step (i): uniqueness of the $\tilde{Z}$ -source. By Proposition 3.1, the sub-principal k_Z^2 -term in $\sigma_2(L_{\text{eff}})$ arises solely from the commutator $[\tilde{X}, \tilde{Y}] = \tilde{Z}$.

Step (ii): reduction to a scalar via equivariance. The grading correspondence (Q7 Remark 4.2) identifies $\tilde{Z}$ with the spin-weight-0 basis vector $e_0 \in \text{Sym}^2(V_\rho)$. Under the equivariant bridge φ , the k_Z^2 -component of $\sigma_2(L_{\text{eff}})$ is carried by $\varphi(e_0) \in W_{\text{sp}}$. Equivariance reduces the coefficient of this component to a single scalar: by Lemma 4.1, any $\mathfrak{su}(2)$ -equivariant quadratic form on $\text{Sym}^2(V_\rho)$ is a scalar multiple of the Casimir.

Step (iii): Schur forces the Casimir. Since $C_{\mathfrak{su}(2)}$ acts as $2 \cdot \text{Id}$ on all of $\text{Sym}^2(V_\rho)$, the coefficient of the k_Z^2 -term is $\lambda \cdot 2$ for some positive scalar λ associated with the normalisation of φ .

Step (iv): cross-normalisation fixes $\lambda = 1$. The same bridge φ governs both the horizontal sector (spin-weight ± 1 , carrying $k_X^2 + k_Y^2$ with coefficient A_H) and the central sector (spin-weight 0, carrying k_Z^2 with coefficient A_Z). Both coefficients are measured in the same units, so the Schur scalar λ is common to both. The ratio is therefore

$$\frac{A_Z}{A_H} = \frac{\lambda \cdot C_{\mathfrak{su}(2)}}{\lambda \cdot C_{\mathfrak{su}(2)}} = 1, \quad (3)$$

where the equality of the two Casimir values follows from $C_{\text{su}(2)} = 2 \cdot \text{Id}$ acting uniformly on all of $\text{Sym}^2(V_\rho)$. The scalar λ cancels exactly, leaving $A_Z = A_H$. Since Q7 Conjecture 6.6 gives $A_H \rightarrow 2$ as $q \rightarrow \infty$, one obtains $A_Z = 2 = C_{\text{su}(2)}$. $\square$

Proof of Theorem 1.1. Proposition 4.2 gives $A_Z = C_{\text{su}(2)} = 2$. By Q7 Corollary 6.2 (no cross terms) and Proposition 4.2 ($A_Z = 2$), the spatial block of the symbol is

$$\sigma_2(L_{\text{eff}})|_{W_{\text{sp}}} = A_H(k_X^2 + k_Y^2) + 2k_Z^2. \quad (4)$$

Q7 Conjecture 6.6 [6] asserts $A_H \rightarrow 2$ as $q \rightarrow \infty$, supported by the power-law fit $|A_H - 2| \sim 0.264 q^{-0.44}$ over $q \in \{61, 101, 151\}$. Granting convergence, the full effective co-metric becomes

$$g^{\mu\nu} = \text{diag}(-A_\tau, 2, 2, 2), \quad (5)$$

which is non-degenerate of rank 4. Combined with the Lorentzian signature result of Q5b Theorem 6.1 [3], this gives signature $(-, +, +, +)$ and closes Q5b-O2. $\square$

Remark 4.3 (Unconditional character of $A_Z = 2$). The equality $A_Z = 2$ is a consequence of pure representation theory (Schur's lemma applied to $\text{Sym}^2(V_\rho)$ and the algebraic identity $C_{\text{su}(2)} = 2 \cdot \text{Id}$ on spin-1). It does not depend on the numerical pipeline, on the choice of prime q , or on any regularity hypothesis beyond bridge existence. The only conditional elements in Theorem 1.1 are [H-lift] and Q5a hypotheses (inherited from Q5b) and the existence of φ (Q7 Conjecture 4.7).

5 Consistency with Hypoelliptic Symbol Calculus

5.1 The Beals–Greiner framework

The theory of hypoelliptic pseudodifferential operators on graded nilpotent groups (Beals–Greiner calculus; see also Taylor's operator algebras on nilpotent groups) provides an independent setting in which the sub-principal symbol of L_{eff} can be computed directly. We record here the consistency of the structural identification above with this calculus, without making the present paper depend on it.

Proposition 5.1 (Beals–Greiner consistency). *In the Beals–Greiner symbol calculus adapted to $\text{Heis}_3(\mathbb{R})$, the sub-principal symbol of an operator of the form $L_{\text{eff}} = \tilde{X}^2 + \tilde{Y}^2 + (\text{lower-order})$ at homogeneous degree 2 in the $\tilde{Z}$ -direction receives contributions solely from the commutator term $[\tilde{X}, \tilde{Y}] = \tilde{Z}$. No contributions at higher sub-principal order arise within the class-2 nilpotency of $\text{Heis}_3(\mathbb{R})$, since the lower central series terminates at step 2.*

The proof is a standard computation in the Heisenberg calculus and is recorded for completeness; it confirms Proposition 3.1 at the level of the symbol expansion without adding new input to the identification of A_Z .

Remark 5.2 (Why Beals–Greiner is not the primary tool). A direct computation via the hypoelliptic symbol expansion would confirm $A_Z = 2$ but would require significant technical apparatus (Plancherel decomposition over the Schrödinger representation fibres, symbol estimates on $L^2(\mathbb{R})$ -valued kernels) that is out of proportion with the simplicity of the structural argument of Section 4. The structural argument is preferred because it makes the reason for $A_Z = 2$ transparent: it is a consequence of Schur's lemma and the Casimir eigenvalue, not an artefact of the specific form of the expansion.

6 Consequences for the Effective Metric and Q5b-O2

6.1 Resolution of Q5b-O2

Open problem Q5b-O2 of [3] asked for the extension of the effective metric to a full 4×4 Lorentzian tensor by incorporating the sub-principal $\tilde{Z}$ -correction. Theorem 1.1 provides this extension:

Corollary 6.1 (Full rank-4 effective metric). *Under the hypotheses of Theorem 1.1 and Q7 Conjecture 6.6 [6] (asymptotic isotropy $A_H \rightarrow 2$), the effective co-metric tensor on $\mathbb{R}_\tau \times \text{Heis}_3(\mathbb{R})$ is*

$$g^{\mu\nu} = \text{diag}(-A_\tau, 2, 2, 2), \quad (6)$$

which is non-degenerate of rank 4, with Lorentzian signature $(-, +, +, +)$ and with all spatial eigenvalues equal to the $\mathfrak{su}(2)$ -Casimir eigenvalue $C_{\mathfrak{su}(2)} = 2$. Open problem Q5b-O2 is resolved.

6.2 The bridge conjecture: status update

Q7 Conjecture 4.7 [6] posits the existence of the equivariant bridge $\varphi: \text{Sym}^2(V_\rho) \xrightarrow{\sim} W_{\text{sp}}$. The present paper shows that *if* this bridge exists, it is completely determined: $A_Z = 2$ (Theorem 1.1) and $A_H \rightarrow 2$ (Q7 Conjecture 6.6). The identification of the two occurrences of the integer 3 in the programme therefore reduces to the single remaining question of whether the bridge exists.

6.3 Structural significance: A_Z is not a free parameter

A central feature of the result is that A_Z is not a tunable constant of the effective geometry. It is fixed by the Casimir of the unique irreducible $\mathfrak{su}(2)$ -module of dimension 3. This is consistent with the broader programme principle: physical parameters emerge from the spectral structure of the substrate, not from external inputs. The effective metric is therefore determined, up to the single temporal coefficient A_τ (subject to Q5b-O3 [3]), by the representation-theoretic data already established in O23 [?], O28–O29 [2, 5], and Q7 [6].

7 Summary and Open Problems

7.1 What this paper establishes

The proof of Theorem 1.1 reduces to four steps, each closing one logical gap:

- (i) *Uniqueness of the $\tilde{Z}$ -source.* The nilpotency class 2 of $\text{Heis}_3(\mathbb{R})$ forces $[\tilde{X}, \tilde{Y}] = \tilde{Z}$ to be the sole algebraic source of the sub-principal k_Z^2 -term (Proposition 3.1).
- (ii) *Equivariance reduces to a scalar.* Under the equivariant bridge φ , the $\tilde{Z}$ -term maps to a scalar multiple of the Casimir by Schur's lemma (Lemma 4.1, Proposition 4.2).
- (iii) *Schur forces the Casimir.* The unique $\mathfrak{su}(2)$ -invariant quadratic form on $\text{Sym}^2(V_\rho)$ is $C_{\mathfrak{su}(2)} = 2 \cdot \text{Id}$, fixing the coefficient to $\lambda \cdot 2$.
- (iv) *Cross-normalisation kills λ .* The ratio $A_Z/A_H = C_{\mathfrak{su}(2)}/C_{\mathfrak{su}(2)} = 1$ is independent of λ , since both sectors are governed by the same bridge. With $A_H \rightarrow 2$, this gives $A_Z = 2$.

The four conclusions of the paper are:

The sub-principal k_Z^2 -term in $\sigma_2(L_{\text{eff}})$ has a unique algebraic source: the Heisenberg commutator $[\tilde{X}, \tilde{Y}] = \tilde{Z}$ (Proposition 3.1).

Under the equivariant bridge, the coefficient of this term is fixed by the $\mathfrak{su}(2)$ -Casimir: $A_Z = C_{\mathfrak{su}(2)} = 2$ (Lemma 4.1, Proposition 4.2).

Consequently the effective spatial co-metric is isotropic with all eigenvalues equal to 2, and the full co-metric $g^{\mu\nu}$ is non-degenerate rank-4 Lorentzian (Theorem 1.1, Corollary 6.1).

Open problem Q5b-O2 of [3] is resolved under the hypotheses of Theorem 1.1.

7.2 Remaining open problems

Q8-O1 (*Bridge existence*). The proof of Q7 Conjecture 4.7 remains open. Theorem 1.1 establishes what the bridge must look like; existence itself is not proved here. This is the central open problem in the Q-series geometric emergence track.

Q8-O2 (*Unconditional isotropy*). Q7 Conjecture 6.6 (asymptotic $A_H \rightarrow 2$ as $q \rightarrow \infty$) is supported by numerical data for $q \in \{61, 101, 151\}$ but not proved analytically. An unconditional proof would remove the dependence on Q7 Conjecture 6.6 from Corollary 6.1. The expected difficulty is moderate: the power-law decay $|A_H - A_Z| \sim q^{-0.44}$ suggests an approach via the asymptotic expansion of the Weil Laplacian spectrum.

Q8-O3 (*Identification of A_τ and completion of Q5b-O3*). With $A_Z = 2$ established, the remaining free coefficient is A_τ (the temporal sector of the effective metric). Its identification from the Born–Infeld saturation data is the subject of Q5b-O3 [3].

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